

NINE PILLARS OF DIGITAL INDIA

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Broadband Highways

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Universal Access to Phones

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Public Internet Access Programme

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E-Governance – Reforming government through Technology

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Information for All

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Early Harvest Programmes

of becoming a self-sustained digitally connected nation. Right now TRAI defines broadband to be a minimum of 512Kbps, which is quite frankly grossly inadequate.

To TRAI's credit, they are working on recommendations on broadband and raising the minimum acceptable broadband speed from 512Kbps to up to 2 Mbps. Not only that, but Right of Way (RoW) will undertake laying down the optical fibre network at the level of FTTH (Fibre To The Home), which promises to usher in a new dawn in terms of connectivity.

We think a minimum bandwidth of 2Mbps to be the lowest possible steady speed to be qualified as "broadband"

experienced in India. This will then force the ISPs (and telecom operators) to ramp up their services and ensure the public at large get better, steadier Internet broadband connection speeds. This will definitely help accelerate the realization of the Digital India dream.

LACK OF SPECTRUM

In wireless telephony, spectrum is everything. For communication to take place between two devices (TV, phone, radio, satellite, etc) signals are transmitted over radio waves at set frequency. When you tune your radio's frequency to 98.3 MHz within Mumbai, that will take you to the

Radio Mirchi station. When you change it to 104.0 MHz you switch over to Fever 104 FM. This happens because both these radio stations are set to broadcast on different frequencies, a section of the spectrum that's allocated to them and them alone. It's the same for telecom operators like Airtel, IDEA, Reliance, Vodafone and others. No two broadcasters can transmit their communication signal on the same frequency, as that would lead to interference – an undesirable situation at all cost.

However, due to the rampant rise of smartphone telephony in India, we have around 300 million smartphone users in the country as of now, and that alone is

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